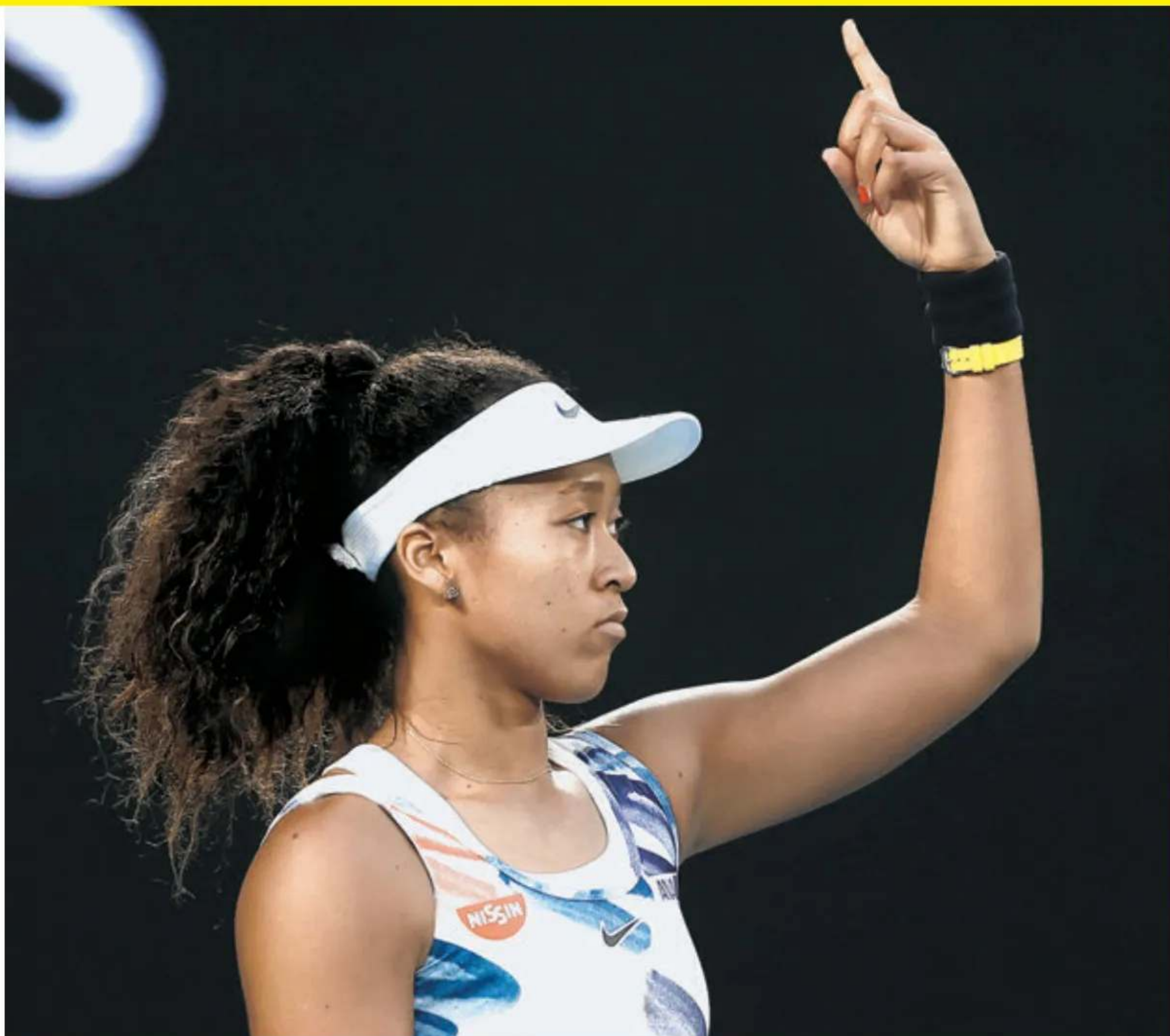




In our out?: In 2025, the ATP Tour will use Electronic Line Calling Live—known as ELC Live—for all ‘out’ calls in all matches. GETTYIMAGES

running hard or at all to return shots, or hitting extremely low-percentage shots to get the match over with as fast as possible. Tanking is one of the worst sins — if not the worst — a tournament tennis player can commit. It also shortchanges and angers spectators, tournament directors, opponents, the media, and sponsors.

ITF sexism — On its website, The International Tennis Federation, the world governing body of the sport for its 213 member nations, proudly

declares, “The International Tennis Federation is fighting bias and discrimination against women in sport.” If so, it should have a Board of Directors that reflects its diverse membership.

Denouncing the longtime and worsening leadership sexism within ITF leadership, Judy Murray, the eminent coach and mother of Andy and Jamie, recently said: “It’s 14 men again.

It was 14 men when I first noticed it back in 2010. And in between time, because of certain people campaigning, there were 12 men and two women. And the two women who were on it were both former players, great players. And this is a global board, and they came

off it because they weren’t being listened to.” Look no further than Pam Shriver, Amelie Mauresmo, Mary Carillo, Leslie Allen, Stacey Allaster, Caroline Wozniacki, and Murray herself. These super seven are more than qualified to serve on the ITF Board of Directors, and their expertise, experience, and judiciousness would make a profound difference.

Now that I’ve gotten my peeves about all these human failures and foibles off my chest, I look forward to happier days in 2024.

Then establishment bigwigs everywhere will show us how open-minded and smart they are as they reform our beautiful, but imperfect sport.